that all ASEAN members abide by their international duties towards refugees.

One solution that has some support among those concerned for the fate of the Rohingyas is the de facto partition of Rakhine, with the northern region created as a semi-autonomous region with its own governance.[3] To assist in this, and to make it easier for the Myanmar authorities to agree, there would be a need to offer substantive economic aid. This might also enable Myanmar to return to the essentially federal structure envisaged by General Aung San in the period immediately after independence.[4]

In effect, arguments for a degree of internal partition are based on the logic that it is more feasible to target the Rakhine local politicians than to directly challenge the Myanmar regime. As we have seen, the charge of inciting genocide is probably much easier to apply to them than to the state authorities.[5] If such individuals were to be charged and threatened with financial embargos and travel bans, this might have two desirable outcomes. First, those who may have been involved in the 2012 violence[6] would face justice. Second, it might help both the NLD and the USDP if the extremist leadership of the ANP was to be directly charged by the international community. Removing such individuals might help create the basis for a gradual return to some normality in Rakhine.

A further strand of action proposed by a number of observers[7] is to improve the level of external monitoring in Rakhine. Not only might it help reduce violence if the current culture of impunity was broken, but the ability to counteract rumours has been found to be critical in other situations with substantial ethnic tension. As we have seen in earlier chapters, many of the more violent episodes have followed on from rumours being spread and believed. The effective separation of the Rohingyas from the wider community makes this more likely. After all, if you never encounter a Rohingya in the course of your normal life it is easier to believe they are rich, funded by the Saudis, buying Buddhist women as wives and, of course, stock-piling arms.[8] In this context, the ability of external voices to challenge rumours may just be the key step that prevents an outbreak of localised violence becoming a more generalised massacre.

This argument broadly suggests the outline of a possible solution. In effect: target the Rakhine extremists and ignore the complicity of the regime in, and the silence of the NLD over, the persecution of the